04-29 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Letter I Found in the Old Suitcase

① Last Saturday my mother asked me to help clean the **small storage room** at the end of our flat. "Everything over ten years old, please show me," she said. "We may give some of it away." I put on an old T-shirt, opened the door, and was hit by a small cloud of dust. In the corner, under a green raincoat, I saw a **dark-brown leather suitcase** with a silver lock. I had never noticed it before.

② The suitcase belonged to my grandmother, who had passed away two years ago. Inside, I found old photos, a pair of wool gloves, a red student booklet, and — at the very bottom — a **small pink paper envelope**, carefully tied with a thin cotton string. The envelope had three Chinese characters on the front, in tidy blue ink: **致亲爱的阿婧** ("To dear Ajing"). My grandmother's name was Zhou Jing. I sat down on the cold floor and looked at the letter for a long minute.

③ My hands shook a little as I untied the string. The letter was four pages long, written on thin yellowing paper. It was from a man called **Xu Qian**, dated **June 1963**. I read slowly. Xu Qian said he had been sent to work in a faraway farm in the north. He described the cold wind, the black soup of wild vegetables, and a small white paper star he had folded from a page of his maths book "so that I do not forget a girl named Jing." He asked if she had been admitted to the teacher-training college. At the end of the letter, he wrote a single line: **"If you ever come to the north, look for the tallest poplar tree. I will be there."**

④ I had never heard of Xu Qian. I ran to the kitchen, where my mother was washing dishes. "Mum," I whispered, holding the letter. "Who is Xu Qian?" My mother stopped. She turned off the water, dried her hands, and sat down slowly. Her eyes looked wet. "Xu Qian was your grandmother's first friend," she said quietly. "Before she met your grandfather."

⑤ That evening my mother told me a small family story I had never been told. Xu Qian and my grandmother had been classmates in a small town middle school. After Grade 9, life sent them in different directions — he to a northern farm, she to a city teacher-training class. They wrote letters for two years, but in 1965 his last letter never came. Later the family heard that he had died of **pneumonia** in a harsh winter. My grandmother kept the letter for **over sixty years**, in different bags, different houses, and finally in that brown suitcase.

⑥ I did not sleep well that night. My strong, quiet grandmother — who used to pour me warm sugar water and teach me to peel a pear with one long curl — had once been a fifteen-year-old girl, waiting for a letter from a boy under a poplar tree. Suddenly she did not feel like "just Grandma". She felt like someone who had been as young and hopeful as I am now.

⑦ On Sunday, I helped my mother carefully put the letter back inside the suitcase, but this time on top, in clear view, not at the bottom. We also took one photo of the envelope and added it to the family album. My mother wrote under the photo: **"Every old person was once a brave young heart."** Closing the suitcase slowly, I understood that cleaning a storage room is not only about throwing things away. Sometimes we find, among the dust, the parts of our family that we had never truly seen.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What did the writer do for her mother last Saturday?

A. She washed all the dishes.
B. She helped clean the small storage room at the end of the flat.
C. She took her mother to a hospital.
D. She cooked noodles for the neighbours.

2. Where did the writer find the letter?

A. In the kitchen cupboard.
B. In her own schoolbag.
C. At the bottom of a dark-brown leather suitcase.
D. In a bookstore.

3. Who wrote the letter, and when?

A. Zhou Jing, in 1965.
B. Xu Qian, in June 1963.
C. Grandfather, in 1975.
D. The writer's mother, in 1990.

4. What did the writer's mother say about Xu Qian?

A. He was a famous actor.
B. He was the writer's grandfather.
C. He was Grandma's first friend, before she met Grandfather.
D. He was Grandma's old teacher.

5. What is the main lesson the writer took away?

A. Storage rooms should be emptied every month.
B. Old people were once young, hopeful hearts; cleaning can help us truly see our family.
C. People should keep all their letters secret forever.
D. Writing letters is a waste of time today.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段
【解析】帮妈妈清理储物间。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段末
【解析】信在棕色皮箱最下面。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "Xu Qian... June 1963"
【解析】徐谦1963年6月写。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段末
【解析】是奶奶遇爷爷之前的第一位朋友。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨归纳题
【定位】第⑥—⑦段
【解析】老人也曾年轻；清理之中有发现。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **suitcase** [n.] 手提箱
- **pneumonia** [n.] 肺炎
- **envelope** [n.] 信封